

Banks watch debit-order strain as households adjust spending

By Ryk van Niekerk | 05 December 2025



Customers using an ATM queue outside a retail banking point

South African lenders are watching debit-order strain after industry files showed a failure rate of about 4.9% in December 2025. Analysts said insufficient funds, recorded at roughly 202 cases in comparable loan payment data, remained the clearest signal of repayment pressure.